

Spenny Piggy - Friday Payout Workflow Guide

This guide explains exactly how the Friday payout process works for you operationally when payouts are manually approved and then sent via Stripe. It is designed as a practical decision guide so you can review, approve, hold, or adjust payouts safely each Friday.

■ High-Level Flow (Your Role)

Think of it like this:

- The system prepares
- You approve
- Stripe executes

■ Your Friday Workflow (Step-by-Step)

1. Open Admin → “Payout Dashboard”

When you log in on Friday, you should open the Payout Dashboard. This is the screen that shows each creator’s current available balance, reserved balance, risk flags, payout status, and what action you can take.

Creator	Available	Reserved	Flags	Status	Action
Creator A	£2,450	£300	None	Ready	■ Pay
Creator B	£1,800	£600	■■ Risk	Review	■ Hold
Creator C	£900	£0	None	Ready	■ Pay

2. System Has Already Done This For You

Before you even log in, the system should already have prepared the payout picture for you.

It should have calculated:

- Earnings for the period Friday to Thursday
- Refunds and chargebacks that need to be deducted
- Reserve deductions
- The available payout amount

It should also already have applied:

- Reserve percentages such as 10%, 15%, 20%, or any manual override
- Any existing holds or flags
- Risk triggers based on the rules engine

3. You Review (This Is Your Main Job)

Your role on Friday is not to calculate anything manually. Your role is to review what the system has prepared and decide whether each creator should be paid, partially paid, held, or escalated for further review.

■ Green light (most creators)

- No flags
- Low dispute rate
- Normal behaviour

Action: click **Approve payout**.

■■ Yellow flag (manual decision)

Examples:

- Sudden spike in earnings, for example £200 to £5,000
- A new creator making big money very quickly
- High-value transactions that are unusual for that creator

Your options:

- Approve anyway
- Reduce payout with a partial release
- Apply a higher reserve percentage
- Hold the payout for the following week

■ Red flag (block)

Examples:

- Suspected fraud
- Chargebacks likely incoming
- Weird or inconsistent payment patterns

Your action should be:

- Do not pay
- Set the account status to "Payout Paused"
- Apply a reserve of roughly 20% to 30% where appropriate
- Add an internal note explaining the reason

4. Click **"Run Payout Batch"**

Once you have reviewed the batch, you then click:

"Send Approved Payouts"

The system should then:

- Send payouts via Stripe
- Log all payout events and actions taken
- Mark the relevant creator records as “Paid”

5. Reserve Release Happens Automatically

Also on Friday, the system should release any reserves that have completed their holding period.

- Old reserves held for 30 days, 60 days, or 90 days unlock
- Those released amounts get added back to the creator’s available balance

This means some creators will have a bigger payout this week because aged reserve balances have now matured and been released.

■ Simple Example

A creator earns £1,000 this week and has a 10% reserve applied.

The system does the following:

- £100 goes into reserved balance
- £900 becomes available for payout

What you see on Friday:

Pay £900

Then, 30 days later, that original £100 reserve is released.

At that point, the creator’s wallet shows:

Available: £100 extra

■ What You Actually Control

You are **not** calculating anything manually.

You are responsible for three things:

- Final risk gate: approve or reject payouts
- Adjust reserves: increase or decrease the reserve percentage where needed
- Pause accounts: if something looks off, stop payout activity

■ How This Scales

Early stage (now)

- You review manually every Friday
- This should take roughly 30 to 60 minutes for around 100 creators

Scale stage

- About 90% of creators are auto-cleared as low risk
- You only manually review flagged accounts

Advanced stage

- Low-risk creators can move to automatic payout approval
- Manual review is reserved for risky accounts only

■■ Important Rules For You

To stay safe from a Stripe, fraud, and operational perspective, you should follow these rules every Friday.

Always review:

- New creators with less than 30 days of history
- Large spikes in earnings or payment activity
- High spenders or unusually concentrated supporter activity

Never auto-pay:

- Accounts with active disputes
- Accounts under review

■ Best Practice Flow

A clean Friday routine should look like this:

- Open the payout dashboard
- Sort by highest earnings and flagged accounts
- Review the top 10 to 20 creators first
- Approve safe ones
- Hold risky ones
- Run the payout batch
- Done

Operational Note

The whole point of this model is that the system handles the maths and the reserve logic for you, while you stay in control of the final decision. That gives you a practical manual approval layer now, while still

creating a process that can scale later into mostly automated payouts with exception-based review.